

Ocean zones

Sunlight sparkles on the surface of the oceans, lighting up marine animals swimming in shallow waters. Deep down on the ocean floor it is another story. There is constant darkness, falling temperatures, and very little marine life. Oceans can be divided into five zones, which relate to the conditions at different depths.



0–656 ft (0–200 m)

Sunlit zone

Sunshine can only reach the shallowest waters. Many marine animals live here. Underwater plants have enough light to make food, in a process called photosynthesis.



Hammerhead shark

Seahorse

Seal

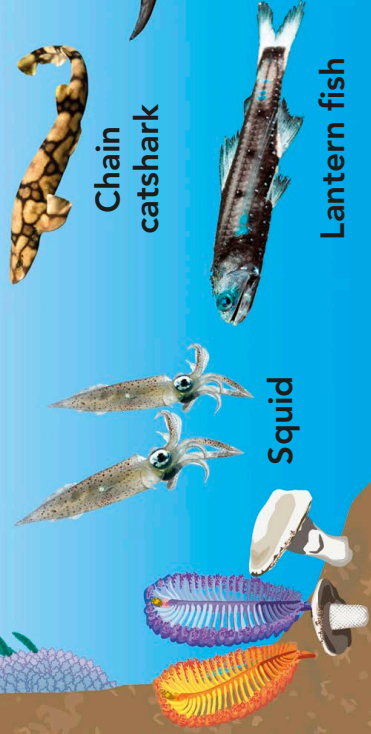


Sea turtle

656–3,280 ft (200–1,000 m)

Twilight zone

Less sunlight means that this zone is much colder and darker than the sunlit zone. Lantern fish and squid have large eyes, which help them see more clearly in the darkness.



Chain catshark

Lantern fish

Squid

Swordfish